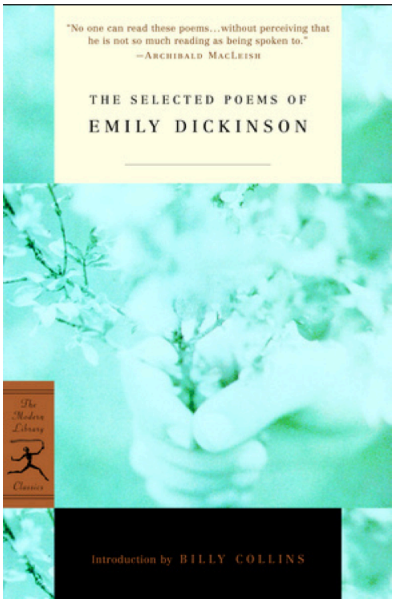
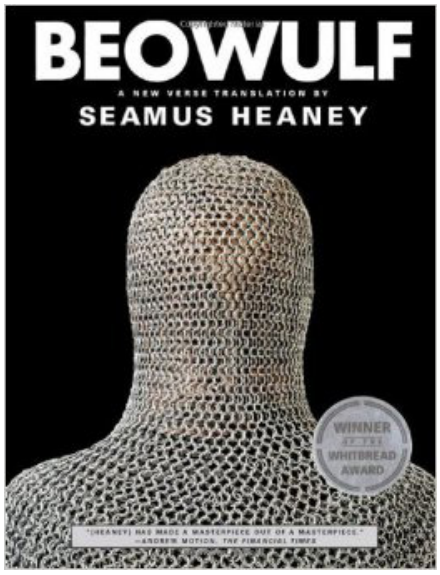
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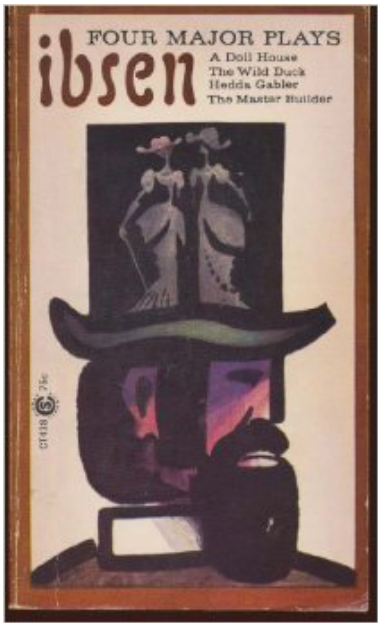
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Invitational A • 2015







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational A • 2015

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The form of verse to be sung or recited and characterized by its presentation of a dramatic or exciting episode in simple narrative form is the
   A) ballad.
   B) madrigal.
   C) pantoum.
   D) rondeau.
   E) round.

2. The poetic foot consisting of an accented and an unaccented syllable, as in the word *happy*, is the
   A) anapest.
   B) dactyl.
   C) pyrrhic.
   D) spondee.
   E) trochee.

3. The rhyme in which the rhyming stressed syllable is followed immediately by an undifferentiated identical unstressed syllable is
   A) beginning rhyme.
   B) compound rhyme.
   C) feminine rhyme.
   D) leonine rhyme.
   E) masculine rhyme.

4. The revival of emotional religion during the first half of the eighteenth century in America is known as
   A) the Great Awakening.
   B) the Harlem Renaissance.
   C) philistinism.
   D) surrealism.
   E) transcendentalism.

5. The period in British history between the execution of Charles I and the restoration of the monarchy under Charles II, during which period John Milton, Andrew Marvell, and Thomas Hobbes wrote, is the
   A) Caroline Age, 1625-1649.
   B) Commonwealth Interregnum, 1649-1660.
   C) Edwardian Age, 1901-1914.
   D) Neoclassic Period, 1660-1798.
   E) Romantic Period, 1798-1870.

6. The continuation of the sense and grammatical construction of a line from one verse or couplet on to the next verse or couplet is
   A) boustrophedon.
   B) caesura.
   C) enjambment.
   D) fused rhyme.
   E) tag-line.

7. The diagram that is often used to reflect the structure of a five-act tragedy is known as
   A) episodic structure.
   B) Freytag's pyramid.
   C) hermeneutic circle.
   D) lipogram.
   E) quintain.

8. The Pulitzer Prize for Poetry was awarded in both 1925 and 1928 to the creator of the fictitious Tilbury Town,
   A) Stephen Vincent Benet.
   B) Robert P. Tristram Coffin.
   C) John Gould Fletcher.
   D) Maxine Winokur Kumin.
   E) Edwin Arlington Robinson.

9. **Not** among the Old English poems probably *composed* during the period 450 -700 CE is
   A) *The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle*.
   B) *Beowulf*.
   C) *Finnsburg*.
   D) "The Seafarer."
   E) "The Wanderer."

10. The name that the *Edinburgh Review* gave to the early nineteenth-century poets Wordsworth, Coleridge, and Southey, among others, living and writing in Cumbria and Lancashire is
    A) Cockney School.
    B) Graveyard School.
    C) Kailyard School.
    D) Lake School.
    E) Metaphysical School.

11. A self-contradictory combination of words or of smaller verbal units is a(n)

A) hyperbole.
B) litotes.
C) oxymoron.
D) paradox.
E) syllepsis.

12. The period in English literature between the return of the Stuarts to the English throne in 1660 and the publication of Coleridge and Wordsworth's *Lyrical Ballads* in 1798 is the

A) Commonwealth and Interregnum.
B) Neoclassic Period.
C) Realistic Period.
D) Renaissance.
E) Romantic Period.

13. The Germanic dialect that was spoken in the British Isles between the invasion of the Angles, Saxons, and Jutes during the fifth century and the Norman Conquest in the eleventh century is

A) Danish.
B) Frisian.
C) Norse.
D) Old English.
E) Romany.

14. The twentieth-century Noble Prize-winning American author of *East of Eden*, *The Grapes of Wrath*, *Of Mice and Men*, and *Travels with Charley* is

A) William Faulkner.
B) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
C) Ernest Hemingway.
D) J. D. Salinger.
E) John Steinbeck.

15. The term, which in drama, refers to a particular kind of play as originally defined in Aristotle's *Poetics* and which recounts a causally related sequence of events in the life of a person of significance, culminating in an unhappy catastrophe, the whole treated with dignity and seriousness, is

A) chronicle play.
B) comedy.
C) melodrama.
D) tragedy.
E) tragicomedy.

16. **Not** among William Shakespeare's major tragedies is

A) *Doctor Faustus*.
B) *Hamlet*.
C) *King Lear*.
D) *Macbeth*.
E) *Othello*.

17. The type of lyric poem that is characterized by its single, unified strain of exalted feeling and style, by its single purpose, and by its dealing with one theme is the

A) aubade.
B) elegy.
C) hymn.
D) ode.
E) sonnet.

18. The nineteenth-century British author whose novels include *A Tale of Two Cities*, *David Copperfield*, *Hard Times*, *A Christmas Carol*, *Bleak House*, and *Oliver Twist* is

A) Charles Dickens.
B) George Eliot.
C) Walter Scott.
D) William Makepeace Thackeray.
E) Anthony Trollope.

19. The presentation of events in a work of literature in such a way that later events are prepared for is called

A) episodic structure.
B) flashback.
C) foreshadowing.
D) prequel.
E) prolepsis.

20. The period in English literary history that begins with the First World War and whose literary voices include the poets Yeats, Eliot, and Hardy and whose experimental fiction includes works by Woolf, Joyce and, to some degree, Conrad is the

A) Caroline Age.
B) Early Victorian Age.
C) Georgian Age.
D) Jacobean Age.
E) Late Victorian Age.

21. The 1985 Pulitzer Prize for Drama went to Stephen Sondheim (music and lyrics) and James Lapine (the book) for their musical

A) *A Chorus Line.*
B) *Of Thee I Sing.*
C) *The Piano School.*
D) *Rent.*
E) *Sunday in the Park with George*.

22. The philosophical movement, characterized by both idealism and romanticism, originating in Europe and reaching the United States during the nineteenth century that featured a reliance on both intuition and the conscience in artistic thought, is

A) existentialism.
B) philistinism.
C) transcendentalism.
D) Unitarianism.
E) vorticism.

23. **Not** one of the characteristics, or features, of Anglo-Saxon and early Germanic poetry, especially epic poetry, is (the)

A) alliteration.
B) caesura.
C) four stressed syllables per line.
D) kenning.
E) masculine rhyme.

24. An analogy identifying one object with another and ascribing to the first object one or more of the qualities of the second is a

A) conceit.
B) metaphor.
C) metonymy.
D) simile.
E) synecdoche.

25. The belief that everything partakes of a hierarchical system, extending upward from inanimate matter, to things that have life but not reason, to the rational human being, to angels, and finally to God is

A) Baconian Theory.
B) Freytag's Pyramid.
C) the Great Chain of Being.
D) Grimm's Law.
E) Ockham's Razor.

26. The Chilean poet, aspirant to the Chilean presidency, and recipient of the 1971 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) Vicente Aleixandre.
B) Camilo José Cela.
C) Nilo Cruz.
D) Gabriel García Márquez.
E) Pablo Neruda.

27. The group of literary and scientific people in and around Cambridge and Boston in the mid-nineteenth century who came together for social intercourse and good conversation, at irregular intervals, is

A) the Brahmins.
B) The Literary Club.
C) the Roundheads.
D) the Saturday Club.
E) the Transcendental Club.

28. The nineteenth-century British author of *Sense and Sensibility*, *Northanger Abbey*, *Pride and Prejudice*, and *Emma* is

A) Jane Austen.
B) Charlotte Brontë.
C) Emily Brontë.
D) Frances Burney.
E) Mary Ann Evans.

29. The Native American author and recipient of the 1969 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for his novel *House Made of Dawn* is

A) Saul Bellow.
B) Michael Chabon.
C) Oscar Hijuelos.
D) Larry McMurtry.
E) N. Scott Momaday.

30. A central idea that in nonfiction prose is recognized as the general topic and in fiction, poetry, and drama is considered the abstract concept made concrete through representation is a(n)

A) climax.
B) *in medias res*.
C) motif.
D) theme.
E) thesis.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Henrik Ibsen's *A Doll House*.

Items 37-42 are associated with Seamus Heaney's translation of *Beowulf*.

Items 43-50 are associated with Emily Dickinson's poetry (selected).

31. That Nora in Henrik Ibsen's *Doll House* is incontrovertibly a dynamic character is emphasized by the

A) banning of macaroons.
B) dancing of the tarantella.
C) decorating of the Christmas tree.
D) mailing of a letter.
E) slamming of a door.

32. Contrasting, during a conversation with Nora, his or her own ability to show compassion with "a bill collector or an ambulance chaser [. . . who] has a little of what they call a heart" is

A) Anne-Marie.
B) Helene.
C) Helmer.
D) Krogstad.
E) Linde.

33. The name that Nora forges on a loan paper to save the life of someone she loves is

A) her banker's.
B) her father's.
C) her husband's.
D) her mother's.
E) her sister's.

34. The character whom Nora describes as "Torvald's best friend from childhood, and *my* good friend, too" is

A) Dr. Rank.
B) Mr. Helmer.
C) Mrs. Helmer.
D) Mr. Krogstad.
E) Mrs. Linde.

35. The revealing pronouncement "I need to have someone to care for; and your children need a mother" defines a potential relationship between the characters

A) Helene and Anne-Marie.
B) Helene and Nora.
C) Linde and Krogstad.
D) Nora and Krogstad.
E) Nora and Torvald.

36. Lost from a "home that's founded on borrowing and debt," according to Torvald, is

A) children's toys and dances.
B) freedom and beauty.
C) friends and relatives.
D) macaroons and toffee.
E) trust and fealty.

37. In the opening passage of Seamus Heaney's translation of *Beowulf*, the "good king" who is described as "a wrecker of mead-benches" and "terror of the hall-troops" is

A) Ecgtheow.
B) Hrothgar.
C) Hygelac.
D) Ingeld the Heathobard.
E) Shield Sheafson.

38. In the Anglo-Saxon epic *Beowulf*, Hrothgar's wife is

A) Hrunting.
B) Hyelac.
C) Unferth.
D) Wealhtheow.
E) Wiglaf.

39. The observation that "every man must yield / the leasehold of his days" points to the Anglo-Saxons' recognition of

A) caesura.
B) kenning.
C) scop.
D) *wergild*, or man price.
E) *wyrd*, or fate.

40. The lines "He announced his plan: / to sail the swan's road and search out that king, / the famous prince who needed defenders" feature a fine example of

A) allusion.
B) apostrophe.
C) flyting.
D) hyperbole.
E) kenning.

41. The reference Beowulf himself offers to "an old reciter, / a carrier of stories" is a reference to what is called in Old English a

A) bard.
B) rhapsodist.
C) scop.
D) skald.
E) troubadour.

42. The line "with spear and sword against constant assaults" is strongly marked by

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) dissonance.
E) onomatopoeia.

Items 43-47 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[Success is counted sweetest]

Success is counted sweetest
By those who ne'er succeed.
To comprehend a nectar
Requires sorest need.

Not one of all the purple host
Who took the flag to-day
Can tell the definition,
So clear, of victory,

As he, defeated, dying,
On whose forbidden ear
The distant strains of triumph
Break, agonized and clear.

43. The first stanza of Dickinson's ["Success is counted sweetest"] is characterized by a marked use of sibilants, which is known as

A) anaphora.
B) asyndeton.
C) epanalepsis.
D) parenthesis.
E) sigmatism.

44. The word *host*, as Dickinson uses it in line 5, means

A) computer server.
B) eucharistic bread.
C) great number.
D) someone who entertains a gathering.
E) victim of a parasite.

45. The continuation of sense and grammatical construction from the second stanza to the third is (an)

A) enjambment.
B) hyperbole.
C) metaphor.
D) simile.
E) tautology.

46. The "distant strains of triumph" (line 11) refer to

A) artillery fire.
B) definitions being offered.
C) ears being forbidden.
D) military music.
E) sounds of soldiers dying.

47. Characterizing victory as the "[taking] of the flag to-day" is an example of

A) hyperbole.
B) metonymy.
C) reification.
D) syllepsis.
E) zeugma.

Items 48-50 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[There is no frigate like a book]

There is no frigate like a book
  To take us lands away,
Nor any coursers like a page
  Of prancing poetry.

This traverse may the poorest take
  Without oppress of toll;
How frugal is the chariot
  That bears the human soul!

48. The first line of Dickinson's poem features a(n)

A) allusion.
B) apostrophe.
C) metaphor.
D) simile.
E) volta.

49. A frigate, as Dickinson uses the term in line 1, is

A) a bird.
B) a fast warship.
C) a poem.
D) a refrigerator.
E) a swear word.

50. The final stanza of Dickinson's ["There is no frigate like a book"] focuses on how

A) chariots outstrip frigates.
B) little a journey-by-book "costs."
C) little it "costs" to use a frigate.
D) oppression dominates a frugal person.
E) strange it is that bears have souls.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-54 refer to Edwin Arlington Robinson's

Credo*

I cannot find my way: there is no star
In all the shrouded heavens anywhere;
And there is not a whisper in the air
Of any living voice but one so far
That I can hear it only as a bar
Of lost, imperial music, played when fair
And angel fingers wove, and unaware,
Dead leaves to garlands where no roses are.

No, there is not a glimmer, nor a call,
For one that welcomes, welcomes when he fears,
The black and awful chaos of the night;
For through it all—above, beyond it all—
I know the far-sent message of the years,
I feel the coming glory of the Light.

*** Latin for 'I believe'**

51. The form of Robinson's "Credo" is the

A) English sonnet.
B) Italian sonnet.
C) Miltonic sonnet.
D) Shakespearean sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

52. Lines 9-14, especially line 10's "welcomes when he fears," sum up the poem's

A) dead metaphor.
B) hyperbolic maxim.
C) overextended cliché.
D) paradoxical message.
E) solemn nonce word.

53. The poem's imagery is

A) auditory.
B) auditory and olfactory.
C) tactile.
D) visual.
E) visual and auditory.

54. The controlling image, the extended metaphor, of Robinson's sonnet is (the)

A) chaos.
B) journey.
C) music.
D) rose.
E) whisper.

Items 55-56 refer to Edwin Muir's

Animals

They do not live in the world,
Are not in time and space.
From birth to death hurled
No word do they have, not one
To plant a foot upon,
Were never in any place.

For with names the world was called
Out of the empty air,
With names was built and walled,
Line and circle and square,
Dust and emerald;
Snatched from deceiving death
By the articulate breath.

But these have never trod
Twice the familiar track,
Never never turned back
Into the memoried day.
All is new and near
In the unchanging Here
Of the fifth great day of God,
That shall remain the same,

Never shall pass away.

55. The references in the second stanza of Edwin Muir's short poem "Animals" comprise a(n)

A) allusion.
B) *fabliau*.
C) parable.
D) rebus.
E) tautology.

56. A scansion of Muir's poem reveals that it is

A) bible verse.
B) blank verse.
C) free verse.
D) heroic verse.
E) shaped verse.

Items 57-60 refer to the Old English poem

The Wanderer
[excerpted]

Often the lone-dweller waits for favor,
mercy of the Measurer, though he unhappy
across the seaways long time must
stir with his hands the rime-cold sea,
tread exile-tracks. Fate is established!
[.....]
When sorrow and sleep at once together
a wretched lone-dweller often bind,
it seems in his mind that he his man-lord
clasps and kisses, and on knee lays
hands and head, as when sometimes before
in yore-days he received gifts from the gift-throne.
When the friendless man awakens again,
he sees before him fallow waves,
sea-birds bathing, wings spreading,
rime and snow falling mingled with hail.
Then are the heart's wounds ever more heavy,
sore after sweet—sorrow is renewed—
when memory of kin turns through the mind;
he greets with glee-staves, eagerly surveys
companions of men. Again they swim away!
Spirits of seafarers bring but seldom
known speech and song. Care is renewed
to the one who frequently sends
over the wave's binding, weary, his thought.

57. The tone of "The Wanderer" is

A) didactic.
B) elegiac.
C) indignant.
D) mocking.
E) optimistic.

58. Lines 44-45 emphasize the pervasive formula

A) *carpe diem*.
B) *in medias res.*
C) *memento mori*.
D) *ubi sunt*.
E) *verbum infans.*

59. The kenning serving to characterize a good king is

A) exile-tracks (line 5).
B) gift-throne (line 45).
C) glee-staves (line 53).
D) lone-dweller (line 1).
E) the Measurer (line 2).

60. Lines 3-4, "across the seaways long time must / stir with his hands the rime-cold sea," describe

A) a boat's captain directing the waves.
B) a Measurer washing his hands in cold water.
C) a pilot losing his way among the waves.
D) a sailor rowing.
E) a swimmer swimming.

Items 61-65 refer to Yvor Winters's

To a Military Rifle

The times come round again;
The private life is small;
And individual men
Are counted not at all.
Now life is general.
And the bewildered Muse.
Thinking what she has done,
Confronts the daily news.

Blunt emblem, you have won:
With carven stock unbroke,
With core of steel, with crash
Of mass, and fading smoke;
Your fire leaves little ash;
Your balance on the arm
Points whither you intend;
Your bolt is smooth with charm.
When other concepts end,
This concept, hard and pure,
Shapes every mind therefor.
The time is yours, be sure,
Old Hammerhead of War.

I cannot write your praise
When young men go to die;
Nor yet regret the ways
That ended with this hour.
The hour has come. And I,
Who alter nothing, pray
That men, surviving you,
May learn to do and say
The difficult and true,
True shape of death and power.

61. The figure on which Winters's poem depends is

A) apostrophe.
B) hyperbole.
C) litotes.
D) metonymy.
E) paradox.

62. The return to the seemingly eternal *dance* of war is echoed, ironically, in the poet's turn to the

A) anapestic trimeter.
B) iambic tetrameter.
C) iambic trimeter.
D) spondaic trimeter.
E) trochaic tetrameter.

63. Winters's clever use of *round*, *private*, and *general* in the poem's opening stanza sets up the poem's thematic

A) ambiguity.
B) hyperbole.
C) litotes.
D) simile.
E) synecdoche.

64. Line 26's "the hour has come" is a "private" repetition of the "general" stated in

A) line 1.
B) line 4.
C) line 12.
D) line 20.
E) line 23.

65. The long-lived "bewildered Muse" (line 6) finds herself having "lost" (line 9) to the rifle, who has deftly out-inspired her, as evidenced by the

A) blunt emblem.
B) fading smoke.
C) news stories.
D) praise not given.
E) unbroken carven stock.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Emily Dickinson's ["The mountain sat upon the plain"], and discuss Dickinson's awareness of and appreciation for the relationships found in nature, as evidenced in ["The mountain sat upon the plain"].

[The mountain sat upon the plain]

The mountain sat upon the plain
In his tremendous chair,
His observation omnifold,* **infinite; many-'perspectived'**
His inquest,* everywhere. **evidence found through investigation**

The seasons played around his knees
Like children round a sire:* **father**
Grandfather of the days is he,
Of dawn, the ancestor.

Emily Dickinson

ANSWER SHEET

UIL Literary Criticism

Items 1-30 **1** *point each*

1. ____
2. ____
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4. ____
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Items 31-65 **2** *points each*

31. ____
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Part 3

contestant number

SCORE

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties.

Simply adjust ranking.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

FIRST GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

SECOND GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

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number correct x 2 _____

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THIRD GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

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number correct x 2 _____

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initials

KEY

UIL Literary Criticism Invitational A • 2015

line arrows up ➔

1.	A	49
2.	E	486
3.	C	196
4.	A	47
5.	B	102
6.	C	174
7.	B	211
8.	E	604
9.	A	517
10.	D	268
11.	C	345
12.	B	320
13.	D	335
14.	E	597
15.	D	480
16.	A	532
17.	D	334
18.	A	558
19.	C	205
20.	C	216
21.	E	608
22.	C	483
23.	E	336
24.	B	294
25.	C	222
26.	E	600
27.	D	429
28.	A	554
29.	E	603
30.	D	476
31.	E	114
32.	D	86
33.	B	66
34.	A	74
35.	C	96
36.	B	44
37.	E	4-11
38.	D	665
39.	E	2591-2
40.	E	199-01
41.	C	2105-6
42.	A	1771
43.	E	
44.	C	
45.	A	174
46.	D	
47.	B	298
48.	D	445
49.	B	
50.	B	
51.	B	260
52.	D	
53.	E	
54.	B	
55.	A	14
56.	C	209
57.	B	
58.	D	489
59.	B	
60.	D	
61.	A	37
62.	C	
63.	A	17
64.	A	
65.	C	

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e, to the Signet *House*, to the Norton *Beowulf*, and to Collins's Dickinson collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Emily Dickinson's ["The mountain sat upon the plain"]

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of the speaker's awareness of and appreciation for nature in Dickinson's poem include

chiasmus,
connotation,
controlling image,
hapax legomenon,
imagery,
metaphor,
personification,
simile,
symbol, and
tone.

The young writer should recognize the mountain's central rôle as paternal precursor to all we encounter in our day-to-day walk through the world, as synecdochally represented by the plain and by the all-embracing seasons.

The contestant might begin a discussion of the relationship between the mountain and the plain by noting the speaker's personification of the mountain, which is followed by a once-removed personification (by way of simile) of the seasons, and the seasons' "playing" might well be understood as simple personification rather than metaphor.

The contestant should recognize and speak to the plain's having evolved from the mountain, perhaps in terms more metaphysical than erosion. The "inquest" (line 4)—the evidence of the mountain's having, like a father, sired the plain around him—suggests , by connotation, the circle of life motif.

The "tremendous chair" (line 2), perhaps a commanding throne, perhaps god-like, initially defines the relationships for which the mountain is central, which is then reinforced by the mountain's guardianship role: his "observation omnifold" (line 3). The description "Grandfather of the days" (line 7) reinforces the guardianship metaphor.

Something might be made of the mountain's relationship to/with the dawn, his being "there" before the dawn's light actually reveals him—thus the mountain as ancestor (line 8).